

Board 1

North Deals

None Vul

♠ 8 3
 ♥ J 10 6 2
 ♦ K J 9 5 4 2
 ♣ 3

♠ K Q J 9 7 4 2

♥ 8 5

♦ 6

♣ 10 7 5

	N	
W		E
	S	

♠ 5
 ♥ 9 7 3
 ♦ A 8 7
 ♣ A K 9 8 6 4

♠ A 10 6

♥ A K Q 4

♦ Q 10 3

♣ Q J 2

West

North

East

South

3 ♠

Pass

4 ♠

All Pass

4 ♠ by North

[showcards W:DA N:D3]

You are West. The bidding has been as shown.

Partner led the ♣A. Seeing your ♣3 he next played the ♦A. What will you play on this trick?

Play the ♦2.

Normally with this holding you would play the ♦9 to encourage East to play a second ♦ through dummy's ♦Q 10.

But this time you really want him to take his ♣K. So play the discouraging ♦2 and hope he gets the message to go back to ♣s. If he does play the ♣K next it will win and he can then give you a ♣ ruff.

Board 3

South Deals

None Vul

♠ 9 8 5
 ♥ K Q 8 5 3
 ♦ 9 6 2
 ♣ J 4

♠ 6 4 2

♥ 9 6 4

♦ K Q 8 3

♣ K 7 3



♠ J 10 7 3

♥ J 7 2

♦ 10 7 5

♣ A 9 5

♠ A K Q

♥ A 10

♦ A J 4

♣ Q 10 8 6 2

*West**North**East**South*

Pass

3NT

2NT

All Pass

3NT by South

obviously 3. And South must also have a third one, so he is up to some trickery with that ♣Q.

So grab your ♣A and return partner's ♥ suit.

[showcards S:CQ]

You are East. The bidding has been as shown.

Partner led the ♥5, you put on the ♥J, South won with the ♥A. The second trick was ♦A, ♦2, ♦3, ♦5. The third trick was ♦J, ♦6, ♦8, ♦7. South then put the ♣Q on the table.

Play the ♣A.

Does it look to you like South is trying to create an entry to dummy so he can cash the 2 ♦ winners?

That's what he wants it to look like, hoping someone holds up their ♣A.

But don't believe Declarer, believe your partner. On the first ♦ West played the ♦2. On the second ♦ he played the ♦6. He has an odd number of ♦s,